## Lymphatic Drainage of the Head & Neck

**1. The lymph nodes of the head and neck are arranged into a regional horizontal collar (outer circle) and a deep vertical chain. Which group forms the posterior-most component of the horizontal collar, draining the posterior scalp?**
a. Mastoid (retroauricular) nodes
b. Preauricular nodes
c. Submandibular nodes
d. Occipital lymph nodes
e. Parotid nodes
**2. Located immediately posterior to the earlobe, overlying the mastoid insertion of the sternocleidomastoid muscle, is a group of nodes that selectively drains the posterolateral scalp and the auricle. This group consists of the:**
a. Parotid nodes
b. Submental nodes
c. Mastoid (retroauricular) lymph nodes
d. Superficial cervical nodes
e. Buccal nodes
**3. The parotid lymph nodes are embedded within or sit superficial to the parotid salivary gland. They receive lymphatic drainage from the root of the nose, the eyelids, the frontotemporal scalp, and the:**
a. External acoustic meatus and tympanic membrane
b. Apex of the tongue
c. Mandibular incisor teeth
d. Midline of the lower lip
e. Submental skin
**4. The submandibular lymph nodes sit inside the digastric triangle in close contact with the submandibular salivary gland. They collect lymph from the upper lip, the lateral parts of the lower lip, the cheek mucosa, and almost all:**
a. Maxillary and mandibular teeth (except mandibular incisors)
b. Intrinsic laryngeal walls
c. Retropharyngeal spaces
d. Posterior one-third tongue segments
e. Thyroid gland lobes
**5. The submental lymph nodes are a small group situated in the midline triangle between the anterior bellies of the digastric muscles. They selectively receive primary lymphatic vessels from the tip of the tongue, the floor of the mouth, and the:**
a. Maxillary third molars
b. Midline of the lower lip and chin skin
c. Soft palate mucosa
d. Palatine tonsil capsule
e. Parotid fascia
**6. Lymph from the submental lymph nodes does not drop immediately to the root of the neck. Instead, it tracks downward and laterally to empty directly into the:**
a. Submandibular lymph nodes and deep cervical chain
b. Occipital nodes exclusively
c. Retropharyngeal nodes
d. Mastoid node clusters

e. Superficial parotid nodes

**7. A cluster of nodes called the facial (buccal) lymph nodes is occasionally found scattered along the course of the facial vein. They serve as temporary checkpoints draining the:**

a. Occipital scalp
b. Soft palate
c. Skin and mucous membrane of the cheek and eyelids
d. External acoustic meatus
e. Sublingual salivary space

**8. The deep vertical chain of cervical lymph nodes is closely associated with which major vascular structure in the neck, wrapped inside the carotid sheath?**

a. External jugular vein
b. Anterior jugular vein
c. External carotid artery
d. Internal jugular vein
e. Subclavian vein

**9. The deep cervical lymph nodes are split into superior and inferior groups by the pathway of which muscle as it crosses the carotid sheath obliquely?**

a. Sternocleidomastoid muscle
b. Digastric muscle posterior belly
c. Omohyoid muscle (inferior/superior belly transition)
d. Scalenus anterior
e. Mylohyoid

**10. A highly prominent, large superior deep cervical node is situated at the junction where the posterior belly of the digastric muscle crosses the internal jugular vein. Because it becomes massively enlarged during acute tonsillitis, it is named the:**

a. Jugulo-omohyoid node
b. Jugulodigastric node (tonsillar node)
c. Principal node of Crowe
d. Virchow's node
e. Delphian node

**11. The jugulodigastric node receives direct lymphatic drainage from the palatine tonsil and which other high-yield oral cavity structure?**

a. Posterior one-third of the tongue
b. Midline of the lower lip
c. Mandibular central incisors
d. Sublingual salivary gland
e. Nasolacrimal duct area

**12. A prominent inferior deep cervical node is located where the intermediate tendon of the omohyoid muscle crosses the internal jugular vein. This node is the:**

a. Jugulodigastric node
b. Jugulo-omohyoid node
c. Submental apex node
d. Supraclavicular checkpoint
e. Prelaryngeal node

**13. The jugulo-omohyoid lymph node is of extreme clinical importance in dentistry because it receives terminal lymphatic vessels from the apex (tip) of the tongue, either directly or via the:**

a. Parotid nodes
b. Occipital nodes
c. Submental lymph nodes
d. Retropharyngeal nodes
e. Mastoid nodes

**14. Lymphatic drainage of the tongue body exhibits a highly structured pattern. Lymph from the lateral margins of the anterior two-thirds of the tongue maps primarily to the:**

a. Submental lymph nodes
b. Submandibular lymph nodes
c. Retropharyngeal nodes
d. Mastoid nodes
e. Superficial parotid nodes

**15. Lymph from the central portion of the anterior two-thirds of the tongue passes vertically downward between the genioglossus muscles to drain directly into the:**

a. Buccal nodes
b. Retroauricular nodes
c. Submental nodes
d. Inferior deep cervical lymph nodes
e. Superficial cervical chain

**16. Lymph from the posterior one-third of the tongue (behind the sulcus terminalis) bypasses all horizontal collar nodes and drains directly and bilaterally into the:**

a. Submental nodes
b. Superior deep cervical lymph nodes (including the jugulodigastric node)
c. Mastoid nodes
d. Superficial parotid nodes
e. Submandibular nodes exclusively

**17. The palatine tonsil possesses an exceptionally rich lymphatic network. Its efferent vessels pierce the pharyngeal wall to terminate almost entirely in the:**

a. Submental nodes
b. Parotid nodes
c. Jugulodigastric lymph node
d. Occipital nodes
e. Infrahyoid strap nodes

**18. The lymph nodes located in the potential space behind the pharyngeal wall, known as the retropharyngeal lymph nodes, receive primary drainage from the nasopharynx, auditory tube, and:**

a. Skin of the chin
b. Mandibular molars
c. Soft palate and posterior nasal cavity
d. Anterior scalp
e. Lower lip vermilion border

**19. Retropharyngeal lymph nodes are prominent in children but tend to undergo complete atrophy or regression by which stage of life?**

a. Birth
b. Puberty / late childhood
c. Middle age (40 years)
d. Atrophy never occurs

e. Infancy (first 6 months)

**20. The superficial cervical lymph nodes are located along the course of which superficial vascular channel, running over the surface of the sternocleidomastoid muscle?**

a. Internal jugular vein
b. External jugular vein
c. Anterior jugular vein
d. Common carotid artery
e. Facial artery

**21. Lymph nodes situated in the midline of the neck anterior to the larynx and trachea are named the prelaryngeal and pretracheal nodes. Their terminal efferents drain into the:**

a. Submental nodes
b. Deep cervical lymph nodes
c. Submandibular nodes
d. Retropharyngeal nodes
e. Mastoid nodes

**22. A single, prominent prelaryngeal lymph node sitting directly on the cricothyroid membrane is known to clinicians as the Delphian node. Enlargement of this node can provide an early clinical alert for malignancies originating in the:**

a. Apex of the tongue
b. Submandibular salivary gland
c. Thyroid gland or larynx
d. Lower lip skin
e. Hard palate mucosa

**23. Efferent lymphatic vessels leaving the superior deep cervical nodes pass downward to join the efferents of the inferior group, consolidating on each side of the neck to form a massive terminal channel called the:**

a. Bronchomediastinal trunk
b. Jugular lymph trunk
c. Subclavian trunk
d. Thoracic duct branch
e. Right lymphatic duct trunk

**24. On the left side of the root of the neck, the jugular lymph trunk terminates by emptying directly into the:**

a. Left external jugular vein
b. Left subclavian artery
c. Thoracic duct (or the junction of the left internal jugular and subclavian veins)
d. Left common carotid artery
e. Coronary sinus

**25. On the right side of the root of the neck, the right jugular lymph trunk typically fuses with the right subclavian and bronchomediastinal trunks to form the:**

a. Thoracic duct
b. Superior vena cava
c. Right lymphatic duct
d. Internal jugular vein bulb
e. Innominate channel

**26. A 58-year-old patient presents with a hard, fixed, painless enlargement of a left supraclavicular lymph node (Troisier's sign). This node is formally called Virchow's node and signifies advanced metastatic spread from a primary carcinoma located in the:**

a. Posterior scalp
b. Maxillary sinus
c. Abdomen or stomach (e.g., gastric carcinoma tracking via the thoracic duct)
d. Frontal bone cortex
e. Upper lip mucosa

**27. Malignant tumors of the oral cavity spread primarily via lymphatic channels (metastasis). Carcinomas involving the tip of the tongue or the central lower lip have a better surgical prognosis if they have not yet tracked to the:**

a. Submental and submandibular nodes, followed by the deep cervical chain
b. Occipital scalp spaces
c. Mastoid bone cortex nodes
d. Retropharyngeal spaces
e. Temporal fossa lymph units

**28. Radical neck dissection is a major oncological procedure performed to excise cancerous tissue. This procedure involves the systematic removal of all deep cervical lymph nodes along with which non-lymphatic vascular structure?**

a. Common carotid artery
b. Internal jugular vein
c. Subclavian artery
d. External jugular vein purely
e. Vertebral artery track

**29. When a surgeon removes the deep cervical nodes during a neck dissection, they use the structural boundaries of the neck triangles to execute the clearance. The lower terminal nodes of the deep cervical chain are located within which specific triangle?**

a. Submental triangle
b. Submandibular triangle
c. Supraclavicular (omoclavicular) triangle
d. Digastric space
e. Upper carotid box

**30. Lymphatic vessels are completely absent within several tissues of the head and neck. Which of the following structures contains zero lymphatic vessels or capillaries?**

a. The skin of the cheek
b. The mucous membrane of the lips
c. Brain parenchyma, dental enamel, dentin, and pulp tissue
d. The capsule of the submandibular gland
e. The muscle bundles of the masseter